of the echelon, Lieutenant Colonel Baranov, and the political officer, Major Guleshov, refused to follow the instructions, claiming that they were responsible to the minister of defense, not the minister of the merchant fleet. It was only after the captain, backed by the KGB officer, insisted that the military men gave up and agreed to remove the canvas from the missiles on deck. The *Blandy* approached the *Divnogorsk* on the right side and then asked that the missiles on the left side be shown as well. Despite the protests of the military men, the captain complied once again.[25]

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THE INSPECTION OF SOVIET SHIPS CARRYING MISSILES BACK to the Soviet Union was first suggested by the Soviet foreign minister, Andrei Gromyko, in his instructions of November 1 to his deputy, Vasilii Kuznetsov, who was about to join Anastas Mikoyan at dinner with the American ambassador to the UN, Adlai Stevenson, and John McCloy. Kuznetsov was instructed, if need be, to offer the Americans photographs of the launch sites once the missiles were removed. "We also," read the instruction, "would have no objections to your ships being shown, at close distance, the missiles loaded on the Soviet ships." Gromyko, undoubtedly acting on behalf of Khrushchev, was looking for a way to make the Kennedy-Khrushchev agreement work, given Castro's refusal to allow inspections on Cuban territory.[26]

The Americans were initially less than enthusiastic. McCloy said that "the Soviet Union and Cuba must agree between each other on what would be the form of inspection," throwing the problem back to the Soviets. But Stevenson was more flexible. "If we fail to carry out ground inspection, let us seek other means which would assure us that the armaments are withdrawn," he told the dinner party. "Otherwise, the danger of conflict will be reborn." Mikoyan did not miss that remark in his report on the dinner discussion. "The American side," he wrote, "would be ready not to insist on verification methods foreseen in the message to N. S. Khrushchev and was ready to look for some new methods that would in essence give the Americans a possibility to be certain of carrying out our commitment to withdraw weapons."[27]